

Lab 2 - OpenClaw Model

Connect OpenClaw to a large language model (LLM).

Lab environment: Hostinger VPS (from Lab 1) or Docker Desktop (Windows 10/11, macOS 12+, Ubuntu 22.04+)

Prerequisite: Lab 1 completed - OpenClaw installed and gateway running. Estimated time: 30 minutes

No API key? Use Option F - Ollama. It runs a model locally with no account and no cost.

How to Run the Model Wizard

The model is configured through an interactive wizard. Run it once and follow the prompts.

VPS: `bash openclaw configure --section model`

Docker Desktop: `bash docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model`

The wizard shows a menu - use arrow keys to select your provider and press Enter.

Option A - Groq (Free Tier, Recommended)

Groq offers a free API with no credit card required.

Step A1 - Sign Up

Visit <https://console.groq.com> → create a free account.

Step A2 - Get Your API Key

Groq console → API Keys → Create API Key. Copy the key - it starts with `gsk_`.

Step A3 - Run the Wizard

```
# VPS
openclaw configure --section model

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model
```

In the wizard:

1. Select More...
2. Find and select Groq
3. Paste your `gsk_...` API key when prompted
4. Select model: llama-3.3-70b-versatile

Option B - OpenAI (API Key)

Step B1 - Get Your API Key

Visit <https://platform.openai.com/api-keys> → Create new secret key. Copy the key - it starts with `sk-`.

Step B2 - Run the Wizard

```
# VPS
openclaw configure --section model

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model
```

In the wizard:

1. Select OpenAI (ChatGPT/Codex sign-in or API key)
2. Choose API key (not OAuth)
3. Paste your sk-... API key when prompted
4. Select model:

Model	Speed	Cost	Best for
gpt-4o-mini	Fast	Low	General agent tasks (recommended)
gpt-4o	Medium	Medium	Complex reasoning
o1-mini	Slow	Medium	Deep step-by-step reasoning

Option C - Anthropic Claude (API Key)

Step C1 - Get Your API Key

Visit <https://console.anthropic.com> → API Keys → Create Key. Copy the key - it starts with sk-ant-.

Step C2 - Run the Wizard

```
# VPS
openclaw configure --section model

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model
```

In the wizard:

1. Select Anthropic
2. Paste your sk-ant-... API key when prompted
3. Select model:

Model	Speed	Cost	Best for
claude-haiku-4-5-20251001	Fastest	Lowest	Lightweight tasks (recommended)
claude-sonnet-5	Medium	Medium	Balanced capability
claude-opus-4-8	Slower	Higher	Complex reasoning

Option D - OpenAI (OAuth - No API Key Needed)

Step D1 - Run the Wizard

```
# VPS
openclaw configure --section model

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model
```

In the wizard:

1. Select OpenAI (ChatGPT/Codex sign-in or API key)
2. Choose Sign in with OpenAI (OAuth)
3. OpenClaw prints a URL - open it in your browser
4. Log in with your OpenAI account and click Allow
5. Return to the terminal - token is saved automatically

Option E - Google Gemini (API Key)

Step E1 - Get Your API Key

Visit <https://aistudio.google.com/app/apikey> → Create API Key. Copy the key - it starts with Alza.

Step E2 - Run the Wizard

```
# VPS
openclaw configure --section model

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model
```

In the wizard:

1. Select Google
2. Paste your Alza... API key when prompted
3. Select model:

Model	Speed	Cost	Best for
gemini-2.0-flash	Fastest	Low	General agent tasks (recommended)
gemini-2.0-pro	Medium	Medium	Complex reasoning
gemini-2.5-pro	Slower	Higher	Advanced multimodal tasks

Option F - Ollama (Local Model, No API Key, No Cost)

Step F1 - Install Ollama

macOS / Linux: ``bash curl -fsSL https://ollama.com/install.sh | sh ``

Windows: Download and run the installer from <https://ollama.com/download>

Step F2 - Pull a Model

```
ollama pull llama3.2
```

Step F3 - Run the Wizard

```
# VPS
openclaw configure --section model

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw configure --section model
```

In the wizard:

1. Select More...
2. Find and select Ollama
3. Enter the host:
 - VPS or native install: `http://localhost:11434`
 - Docker Desktop: `http://host.docker.internal:11434`
4. Enter model name: `llama3.2`

Verify Model is Connected

After completing the wizard:

```
# VPS
openclaw models status

# Docker Desktop
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw models status
```

Expected output: `` Provider: <your provider> Model: <your model> Status: ☐ Connected ``

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
Unknown command: <code>openclaw model</code>	Use models (plural) - <code>openclaw models status</code>
<code>--api-key</code> not recognised	Use the wizard: <code>openclaw configure --section model</code>
Groq key rejected	Key must start with <code>gsk_</code> - re-copy from console.groq.com
OpenAI key rejected	Key must start with <code>sk-</code> - re-copy from platform.openai.com/api-keys
Anthropic key rejected	Key must start with <code>sk-ant-</code> - re-copy from console.anthropic.com
Ollama not found	Start Ollama first: <code>ollama serve</code> then retry
Docker: Ollama unreachable	Use <code>http://host.docker.internal:11434</code> not localhost

Symptom	Fix
models status shows disconnected	Re-run openclaw configure --section model and re-enter the key

Reference

- Providers: <https://docs.openclaw.ai/providers>
- Groq (free): <https://console.groq.com>
- OpenAI: <https://platform.openai.com>
- Anthropic: <https://console.anthropic.com>
- Google AI Studio: <https://aistudio.google.com>
- Ollama: <https://ollama.com>